

The Jews of Madinah

The Jews of Madinah were on a different footing. They joined with the Madinah in a welcome to Muhammad (Sm). The Prophet, at the beginning, acknowledged the divine authority of their religion, and had even rested his claim upon the evidence of their Scriptures. In order to maintain friendly relation with the Jews, the Prophet even adopted some of their customs and ceremonies. The Jews at first thought that they would be able to win over Muhammad (Sm) to their party. But when they found that their hopes were not to be fulfilled, they gradually withdrew their support and became the arch enemies of Islam.

Political state of affairs at Madinah :

Political Institutions : On his coming to Madinah the Prophet devoted himself to the organisation of the State. The old inhabitants of Madinah, the Aws and the Khasraj fell out among themselves. Taking advantage of their self-interest, they were playing one against the other. As a result of their diplomatic hostility, there was no peace and order in the land the citizens of Madinah lived in constant anxiety and suspense. When such was the political condition of Madinah, Muhammad (Sm) appeared before them.

Establishment of brotherhood between Ansar and Muhajirun, The Charter :

The Prophet at first abolished the tribal distinction and grouped the inhabitants of Madina under one general name Ansar or Helper. In order to unite the Ansar and the Muhajirun or Emigrants in closer bonds, he established a brotherhood between them. It was a brotherhood based not on kingship or blood but the faith, which linked them together in sorrow and happiness. He also realized the truth that the foundation of the Islamic empire would be very weak unless it was based upon the goodwill and co-operation of all sections of people. Toleration of the others' religion is essentially necessary where different races live together. In this respect his policy was "Live and let live others." He wanted to organize the State on the basis of co-operation between the Muslims (Ansar and Muhajirun) and the Jews. With this end in view he had granted a Charter which is commonly obligations of the Muslims and the Jews in Madinah were clearly defined. The main provisions of the Charter are the followings:

Provisions of the Charter :

- (1) All the communities signing the Charter would form the common nationality.
- (2) If any of the signatories was attacked by an enemy, others would defend him with their combined forces; but
- (3) None of the Nationality should come into terms by any sort of secret treaty with the Qurayshite or should give shelter to any of the Qurayshite or should help them in any of their designs against the Medinites,
- (4) Muslims, Jews and other communities of this Republic should be free to profess their own respective religions and perform their religious ceremonies. Nobody could interfere in it.
- (5) 'Individual and personal offence of a trivial nature of any non-Muslim would be treated as such and no general liability would fall on the community to which the offender belonged.'
- (6) The oppressed should be protected.
- (7) Henceforth bloodshed, murder and violence should be haram (forbidden) in Madinah.
- (8) Muhammad (Sm), the Prophet of Allah, would be the

President of the Republic and by virtue of it would be the highest Court of Appeal in the land.

Importance of the Charter :

The importance of the Charter lies in the fact that it may be regarded as the First Written Constitution in the annals of the world. Before the Prophet of Islam, many rulers rule but none gave such a **Written Constitution** to his people. The Charter may also be called **the Magna Charta early Islam**. It announced the great principles of **civic equality, freedom of worship and religious tolerance**. It was Muhammad (Sm.) who, for the first time, realised the importance of the people's co-operation and goodwill in the administration of the country. The Charter proves that Muhammad (Sm.) was not only a religious preacher, but also one of the greatest **statesmen the world has ever produced**. In this connection, W. Muir says, "It reveals the Man in his real greatness-a **master-mind, not only of his own age, but of all ages.**" The provisions of this Charter show that he not only strengthened his hands against the Quraysh but also established his paramount position in the city of Madinah.

Treaty of Hudaibiah : Circumstances leading to the treaty of Hudaibiah :

It was **long six years** that, the Muslims had left Makkah for the sake of their religion and since then they had not the chance to perform the pilgrimage and even visit their own country. After the battle of the Ditch, the Muslims became very eager to visit their hearths and homes. The Prophet realised the strong desire of **their hearts** and announced his decision to visit Makkah. In the sixth year of the Hijrah (**628 A.D**) he started for Makkah with 1,400 companions to perform the pilgrimage. It was the month of Dhul Qa'da **when war was unlawful** throughout Arabia. But the Quraysh did not want the Muhammad (Sm.) would enter into the Makkah and perform the pilgrimage. So when they were informed of the approach of the Prophet, they came hurriedly to oppose his advancement. Thus being opposed the Prophet took a different route and halted at a place named Hudaibiah, nine miles off Makkah, and called a council of leading men to let them know his real intention. But the Quraysh were determined not to allow the Prophet and his follower to enter Makkah. They informed the Prophet that he should go back that year and in the following years he might come when they would leave the city to him for three days. He then dispatched Uthman as messenger to inform the Qurayshite leaders that he had no other intention except the performance of pilgrimage. But they were still adamant in their determination. At that time a **rumour** spread that Uthman was murdered by the Quraysh. This caused a great commotion in the Muslim camp. The Prophet sat under a tree and asked his followers to offer the oath of allegiance called **Bay'at ar-Ridwan** to him. They submitted to it, declaring their resolves to fight to the bitter end for the cause of Islam. Fortunately Uthman came back after a few days.

Terms of the treaty :

The Quraysh became afraid and at last agreed to come to terms with the Muslims. A treaty was concluded known as the treaty of Hudaibiah between the Quraysh and the Prophet. It was decided in the treaty that war would be suspended for ten years. Whoever wished to join Muhammad (Sm.) or enter into

treaty with him, should have the liberty to do so and, likewise, those who wished to join the Quraysh or enter into treaty with them were quite at liberty to do so. If anybody went over to Muhammad (Sm.) without the permission of his guardian he should be sent back to his guardian but should any of the followers of Muhammad (Sm.) return to the Quraysh he should not be sent back. Muhammad (Sm.) should retire that year without entering the city. In the coming year Muhammad (sm.) might visit Makkah with his followers only for three days during which the Quraysh should retire and leave the city to him and his followers. But they might not enter it with any weapons, save those of the travelers.

Importance of the treaty : A grate victory for Islam :

The treaty of Hdaybiah was a great victory for Islam. At first the Muslims were disappointed. specially Umar, for **unfavorable terms of the Treaty** and in order to dispel the idea of the Muslims the following verse of the Quran was raveled to the Prophet : "Verily we have given unto thee a clear victory." ¹ The terms in the treaty show the greatness of the Prophet and the superiority of the cause. Through the treaty seemed outwardly humiliating on the part of the Muslims, it gave Muhammad (Sm.) great advantages. His political status as an independent power was acknowledged by the treaty moreover, **the ten year's truce gave time and opportunity for Islam to expand and force its claims upon the conviction of the Quraysh**, while conquest-political and spritual-might be followed on every other side. as a result of this treaty, a great number of people joined the faith of Muhammad (Sm.) Zuhri, the biographer of Muhammad (Sm.) says, "There was no man of sense of judgment amongst the idolaters who was not led thereby to join Islam." great warriors like Khalid Bin Walid and Amr Ibn- Al As embraced Islam after the treaty of Hdaybiah inthis connection Ibn Hisham says that at Hdaybiah the Prophet had **fourteen hundred** followers with him but two years later in the attack on Makkah he was followed by **ten thousand** Muslims.

The Prophet at Makkah

Makkah, the home of the Ka'bah and the birth-place of the Prophet had not been brought under his away. But soon a chance came which gave him the opportunity to extend his domination there.

The Conquest of Makkah : Treaty of Hdaybiah violated by the Quraysh :

The treaty of Hdaybiah allowed the Khuza tribe to declare⁴ their adhesion to Muhammad (Sm.) and Banu Bakr tribe to the Quraysh But when the truce of Hdaybiah had been nearly two years in force, the Banu Bakr tribe, in collaboration with party of the Quraysh, attacked the Khuza by night abd slew several of them. A deputation of forty men from the injured tribe approached the prophet for help and Muhammad (Sm.) was compelled to take up their cause for political and religious reasons.

Peace mission sent by the Prophet rejected :

The Prophet first sent a **peace mission** to the Quraysh with alternative proposals that they were to pay proper indemnity to the injured Khuja tribe, or (b) to cut of all connections with the Banu Bakr tribe, or (c) to declare the treaty of Hdaybiah null and void. The Quraysh accepted the last proposal. The messenger came

back and informed the Prophet of all about it. The Prophet understood that there was no other alternative but to wage war against the Quraysh. He resolved on an immediate attack on his native city. Abu Sufyan then realised his mistake in rejecting the peace-mission and dispatched a messenger to the Prophet for maintaining the compact of peace. But the Prophet, without any further delay ordered his followers to march on Makkah. On January 1, 630 A.D he advanced upon Makkah with an army of 10,000 men and it was the largest force Madinah had ever seen. Finding himself unable to oppose the Muslims, Abu Sufyan with two other companions came out from Makkah to see the fire on the height above the camp of the Prophet but he had not to go far when he was arrested and brought to the presence of Muhammad (Sm.) who pardoned his lifelong enemy. He then accepted Islam.

Muhammad entered into Makkah :

The Prophet entered the city of his birth without any opposition and planted the great banner of Islam at the door of his tent. The rebellious city now lay at the feet of the abused, rejected and exiled Prophet,

Conquest of Makkah unparalleled :

The European historians have admitted that " through all the annals of conquest there has been no triumphant entry like into this one." No conquest was made without bloodshed and no forgiveness was shown like this one to the vanquished in the history of the world. The Prophet and his followers had been oppressed and persecuted in Makkah for long thirteen years and the oppression had ultimately compelled them to migrate to Madinah. But when they entered into Makkah, they forgave every injury inflicted on them and 'a general amnesty was extended to the Makkans irrespective of their past record of crimes.' The bitterest enemy of Islam and of the world.

The conquest of Makkah opened a new era in Islam. It practically decided the struggle for supremacy in Arabia and the Prophet was elevated to a paramount position over the whole peninsula. With his entry to Makkah, truth came and falsehood vanished.

The Farewell Pilgrimage:

(In the 10th year of the Hijrah, the Prophet felt that his mission was complete and understanding the end of his life near, he determined to make a farewell pilgrimage to Makkah.) On the 23rd February, 632 A.D. he started for Makkah with a large number of Muslims. During this time all his wives accompanied him. The Prophet had taken one hundred animals to sacrifice at Mina.

When Hazrat Muhammad (Sm.) reached Dhul Hulaifa, he encamped and passed the night there. The next morning, he had all his followers pull on the pit on the pilgrim's garb (Ihram). In this garb all people stood before their Lord as equals.

(On the 11th day, the Prophet entered into the city of Makkah.) as soon as he reached there, he hastened to the Ka'bah and made seven circuits of the House of God. Then the Prophet prayed at the station of Abraham, after which he went out to make seven runs between the hills of Safa and Marwa. By the command of

Muhammad (Sm.) all those who had no presents to offer shaved their heads and were free from the restriction of Ihram for the time being.

The Sermon on the Mount Arafat :

On the 8th of Zil-Hajj the Prophet left Makkah for Mina and passed the night there. After morning prayers, he rode the camel, Caswa and proceeded to Arafat in the company of his followers. Before completing all the rites of the pilgrimage, he addressed the assembled multitude from the top of the Jabal-UI-Arafat. The speeches which he delivered on this occasion are still fresh in the memory of every Muslim.

"O people! listen to my words; for I do not know whether I shall be in your midst after this year. Remember that you shall have to appear before your Lord who will demand from you an account of all your actions."

"O people! you have rights over your wives and your wives have rights over you..... Treat your wives with kindness. Verily, you have taken them on the security of Allah and made them lawful unto you by the words of Allah." And feed your slaves as you feed yourselves and clothes your slaves as you clothe yourselves. If they commit a fault, which you are unwilling to forgive, then part from them for they are the servants of Allah and are not be harshly treated."

"O people! listen to my words and remember that all Muslims are brothers unto one another. As you are one another. As you are one brotherhood, you will not take your brother's belongings which he will not give you out of goodwill. Guard yourself from committing injustice."

"Let him that is present tell it unto him that is absent. Haply he that shall be told may remember better than he who hath heard it."

With these words the Prophet finished his address when a revelation came to him.

" This day, Have I perfected for you your faith,
And completed My blessing upon you,
And have accepted for you Al-Islam as Religion."

-Al-Quran : V.-3

Completion of Hajj, Ethical value of the Sermon :

The Prophet immediately recited this verse to all present he left Arafat about evening and passed the night in prayers together. In the morning he arrived at Masha'ril Haram and went on to Mina and passed the Jamarat (stone-throwing station) on his way. He then sacrificed sixty-three camels one for each year of his life and sacrificed the rest of the hundred camels which the Prophet had brought from Madinah. after this ; he shaved his head and the Hajj was thus completed. In this farewell Sermon he pointed out in brief the duties and responsibilities of every Muslim towards each other. On the basis of these teachings , the later history of Islam has been moulded. Women get a unique position in the society and status of slaves was raised to an unparalleled degree. islam teaches us no distinction between master and servant. It establishes the fact that a slave of to-day may be a king of tomorrow provided that he had got the requisite

qualification. the history of so-called Slave Dynasty of India is a clear proof of this teaching.

Expedition to Syrian frontier, Death of the Prophet :

Two months after his return from the farewell pilgrimage, Muhammad (Sm.) gave order for an expedition to the Syrian frontier. He appointed Usamah, son of Zayd, as the commander for the expedition. But he could not see his Syrian conquest complete he fell ill in the 10th year of the Hijrah and on the 5th day of his illness he went to the house of A'ishah where he breathed his last and was buried on the 8th June, 632 A.D. Thus ended the brilliant and glorious career of the greatest man of Arabia, nay of the whole world.

Evaluation of Muhammad (Sm.) As a Reformer :

The Prophet of Islam was the greatest reformer the world has ever produced. Before his Advent, Arabia nay the whole of the known world, was steeped in vice, superstition and barbarism. Social inequality, degraded womanhood, slavery, drunkenness, debauchery, gambling, rapacity, blood thirstiness and such other heinous vices were prevalent among the Arabs never was the people so low as the Arabs were, nowhere was idolatry so deep-rooted as in Arabia no Prophet before Hazrat Muhammad (Sm.) seems to have thought of tackling these horrible problems. He ruthlessly attacked them one after another till they were gone.

Political :

The tribal feuds and raids made Arabia a land of constant unrest. Political disunity prevailed all over the Peninsula the Prophet brought about the union of all the warring tribes and thereby welded the ever-quarreling Arab tribes into a mighty nation. This Arab nation forgot " the days of the Arabs" when they knew nothing but mutual killing and internecine disputes and unending raids, plunder and butchery. This was the political miracle of the Prophet he brought the Arabs under a single government established in Madinah. The people were given equal voice in the determination of the policy of the government. The Prophet framed a systematic code and ensured peace and prosperity in the country.

Religious:

The Arabs were equally corrupt in the field of religious life they were idol-worshippers and were steeped in every kind of superstition they divided their gods into male and female. There were 360 idols in the Ka'bah. The Arabs used to worship them till they were vanished by the Holy Prophet. Muhammad (Sm.) inspired the idol worshippers with the idea of one God. They began to forget these deities and worship in the name of one God within a brief span of about twenty-three years he transformed the impious Arabs into a religious nation.

Economic:

The Prophet was a great socialist he found that the people were being exploited economically by a section of people who practised usury. He made it haram(forbidden) and introduced the system of Zakat, Sadkah and Fitr in the

society. The distribution of wealth in the society dealt a death blow to the capitalism. He also encouraged the people to turn their attention to trade and agriculture. These contributed to the building of national economy.

Social; Removal of social inequality:

Of all the reforms initiated by The Prophet of Islam, the removal of social inequality was the most important and far-reaching in consequences he could not find any reason for any distinction between man and man on account of a mere accident of birth in a particular family or particular country. He broke down all artificial barrier which society had set up to fortify privileges of wealth, work or colour. "All human beings," he declared " were equal and the highest rank was his who has the most obedient to Allah and most useful to mankind." he thus established a world wide brotherhood, which welded high and low, rich and poor, white and black into one fraternity "Allah does not look at your lineage or face", says the Prophet, "but He looks into hearts. He among you that is most favoured of Allah is the one that is most pious." The aim of Hazrat Muhammad (Sm.) in this respect was to bring the whole of humanity on one common platform as one class, one community and one nation having the same ideals and sharing the equal privileges.

Abolition of slavery:

The Prophet took steps to abolish the slavery system which had been in vogue among the Arabs slavery was also prevalent among the Greeks, the Romans, the Jews and the Christians who treated the slaves most inhumanly possessing the power of life and death over them. The Christian adopted slavery as a recognised institution and nothing was done for the welfare of the slaves. It was Hazrat Muhammad (Sm.) who did all that were possible to raise the status of the slaves he emphatically declared that there was no service more acceptable to God than the emancipation of slaves. He purchased the slaves to set them with kindness and justice.

Administration under the Prophet (Sm.)

The Provinces : Division of Arabia into Provinces, Wali, Amil, Qazi :

After unifying the country, the Prophet Muhammad (Sm.) divided it into several Provinces on the basis of past history and geographical position. The Provinces were Madinah, Makkah, Tayma, Janad, Yaman, Uman, Najran, Bahryan, and Hadramawat. Madinah was the capital of the whole Islamic State and the administration of these provinces was under the direct control of the Prophet. There was one Governor in each Province. The Provincial Governor was called Wali. He was appointed by the Prophet and was responsible to him for his works. He had to perform the same functions within his area as the Prophet used to do in Madinah, except those in connection with the prophetic works. He was the Imam of the congregational prayer, the Commander-in-Chief, the judge and the administrator. Besides the Governors, The Prophet appointed Amils (collectors) over each tribal area to collect Zakat (poor-tax) and Sadaqah (voluntary alms).¹ The Prophet himself acted as the Qazi (Judge) of Madinah. The Judges of other Provinces were either appointed directly by him or the Governors were directed to appoint persons selected by Him.

The Revenue System : Sources revenue :

There was no central authority in the pre – Islamic days. So, nobody knew anything about the income and expenditure of the Government. It was the Prophet who first established a Central Government in Arabia. He was the first, who instituted a public treasury in Madinah. during the days of the Prophet the Islamic State had five sources of revenue : namely, (1) Zakat (poor-tax) and Sadaqah (Voluntary alms), (2) Jizya (Capitation –tax), (3) Kharaj (land-tax), (4) Ghanimah (spoils of war) and (5) Al-Fay(State lands).

1. At-Tabariy, Zakat :

In order of importance Zakat has been given the second place in the Quran. It is compulsory (Farz) for all well-to-do Muslims. Zakat was levied on different form of properties. It was levied on (a) animals, i.e. camel, cattle and other domestic quadrupeds, (b) grains, fruits, dates, etc., (c) gold and silver and (d) merchandise.

Ushr :

A certain minimum of property (an-nisab) was laid down which would make one liable to pay Zakat. As for example, gold or silver below the value of 200 dirhams was free from this tax. 'The Zakat on land produce was collected at 10%, if the land was watered by stream or rain.' " This tax on land was called Ushr. A person had to pay Zakat on his land, when the yield from the land exceeded five ass-loads. In the case of merchandise and even gold and silver a Zakat of 2.5% was levied.

Jizya :

Jizya was levied on the Non-Muslims in lieu of military services and for the protection on their lives and properties. The Muslims used to return the Jizya in case of their failure to protect the lives and properties of the non-Muslims. In the days of the Prophet every male member capable of paying the Zakat was required to pay only one dinar per year. This tax was not new. Before Hazrat Muhammad (Sm.) it was prevalent in Persia under the name of gezit and in Rome under the name of tributum capitis.

Kharaj :

Non-Muslims had to pay Kharaj (land-tax) for possessing land. The institution of Kharaj which was prevalent among the Persians and the Romans, first came into being in Arabia after the conquest of Khaybar by the Muslims. The Prophet fixed half of the produce of their land as Kharaj.

Ganimah :

Weapons, horses and other movable properties were included in the Khaums or Ganimah. These articles when left by the unbelievers in the battle-field were distributed among the Muslim

portion of the booty was used 'according to the instructions of the Quran for the support of the Prophet's relatives, the needy and way-farers and for the general good of the Muslim community.'

Al-Fay :

The word Al-Fay' was generally applied to the lands in the conquered territories which came under the possession of the State. There were certain crown lands under the Prophet and the income of these lands was utilized for the general good of the Muslim Community.

The Army, Commander-in-Chief of the Army, Discipline :

The Prophet was the Commander-in-Chief of the Muslim army. He took part in 26 or 27 battles and expeditions. But he himself led the Muslim forces in all important battles and campaigns like the battles of Badr, Uhud and Hunayn and the conquest of Makkah. The smaller expeditions were led by a military commander appointed by him. There was no regular army. When there was necessity of sending military expedition, summons were issued to the allied tribes and the Muslims in general to assemble for the purpose. At first the Muslim forces were only an assemblage of small bands but during the later years of the Prophet's life they were turned into a vast army. In the first battle of Islam (i.e. the battle of Badr) the Muslim army consisted of only 312 soldiers but in the Tabuk expedition (last campaign undertaken by the Prophet) thirty thousand soldiers had taken part. There was strict discipline among the soldiers and every one of them had to maintain high standard of morality. Breach of discipline was subject to rigorous punishment.

Educational System, Encouragement of education by the Prophet, Centre of education at Madinah : Schools in each 'mohalla' :

Though the Prophet had no institutional education, he 'was an ardent advocate of the pursuit of knowledge incumbent upon all his followers, irrespective of sex and rank. He also says, " Seeking of knowledge is obligatory for all Muslims- male and females" (Talabul Ilme Faridatun Ala Kulle Muslemin wa-Muslimatin). He always encouraged the Muslims to acquire knowledge. After his migration to Madinah, educational institutions were established there under his initiative. Some of the Qurayshites conversant with the art of reading and writing were arrested by the Muslims in the battle of Badr, and they were released on condition that each of them would teach writing and grammar to ten Muslim children. Thereafter literacy and education began to spread rapidly among the Madinites. Madinah became the centre of religion and education. Nine mosque-schools were established in Madinah and of these, the mosque-school of Quba, suburb of Madinah was the most important. The Prophet used to go there to talk and discuss with the students, The women were also taught along with men. The Prophet used to say that 'even the slave-girls must be educated and then set free'. In each 'mohalla' of the city primary schools were established for the education of little children. When Islam was gaining ground all over Arabia, the Prophet arranged to send mu'allim or teachers to teach the Holy Quran to Bedouin tribes.

Abu Bakr the Apostasy Movement : Meaning of the 'word' 'Riddah' :

The short caliphate of Abu Bakr was mostly spent in Riddah wars. "Riddah" is an Arabic word which means session or apostasy. As soon as the news of Prophet's death was noise abroad, the Arabs throughout the Peninsula were relapsing into their old faith. They raised the standard of revolt against the Prophet's successor, Abu Bakr. The time was very critical for Islam. Hazrat A'ishah, wife of the Prophet said about it, 'When the Prophet died, the Arabs apostatised and the Christians and Jews raised their heads and disaffection appeared. The Muslims became as sheep exposed to rain on a winter's night through the loss of their Prophet until God united them under Abu Bakr. " The leaders of rebellious tribes and the false prophets organised a movement against Islam. The movement led by them in order to return to idolatry after renouncing Islam was known in history as Apostasy Movement and the war waged against them by Abu Bakr was called the war of Apostasy or Riddah war. While the false prophets made their own tribes to renounce Islam, some other Arab tribes apostatised it on other grounds. There were causes which led the unruly tribes to rise in revolt against Islam.

Ascendancy of Madinah, Result of democracy, Reaction against the charges, Fascination for the prophetic office, Lack of true faith, Strict rules of morality enforced by Islam and Objection to Zakat :

Causes : The ascendancy of Madinah became an eye-sore to the Makkans who did not want the supremacy of the sister city. So long as the strong personality was the Prophet was there, they remained in sullen silence. But the demise of the Prophet gave them an opportunity to over through the influence of the Medinites and the national characteristics of the Arabs which had been held in check by the Prophet, began to raise their heads. Secondly the tribes of Arabia obeyed the order of their leaders and followed their auction blindly even at the advent of Islam. so when their leaders became Muslims, they followed them in good faith. But as time went on, the wave of democracy was running high throughout the peninsula. As a result, all individuals of the tribe refused to follow the action of their leaders. Thirdly a through change was brought by the Prophet of Islam over the social, political and religious conditions of Arabia. the tribes of Arabia were not a accustomed to these and hence they protested against these changes by rising in open rebellion. Fourthly, Many of the Arab tribes thought the prophetic office to be profitable and so they persuaded the Arabs to support them with a view to fulfilling their object. These chiefs gave false promise to the people and inspired them to standup against the Muslims. Fifthly the people had just joined the fold of Islam when the Prophet had passed away. The people who could not get much time and opportunity to go into the inner spirit of Islam were ignorant of its true worth and spirit. And hence they relapsed into their tribal customs and creeds and once more challenged the authority of Islam. Sixthly, the strict rules of morality enforced by Islam were to hard for the Arabs of the desert who loved license and indulgence of the old pagan ways which placed no restrictions upon drinking and other pleasures. Lastly, the Arab's unwillingness to pay the poor-tax (zakat) led people of different centres under different leaders to rise against Islam.